SHOC SOPs 7

Security and Access SOPs

Govern facility access, personnel safety, asset protection, and integrity of SHOC operations.

SADC Humanitarian Emergency Operations Centre, Nacala, Mozambique

SADC HUMANITARIAN AND EMERGENCY OPERATIONS CENTRE

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURES

Security and Access

SOPs 7.1, 7.2 & 7.3

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1. Purpose and Objective

The SADC Humanitarian and Emergency Operations Centre (SHOC) operates in a dynamic, high-risk environment where access control, personnel security, and facility/asset protection are critical to ensuring the safety of personnel, the continuity of operations, and the safeguarding of key assets.

SOP 7.1 — Access Control and Security Reporting establishes a unified, auditable system for managing access to SHOC facilities, ensuring that physical access, security infrastructure, and incident reporting are tightly controlled across all phases of the UNDAC ERT Mission Cycle.

SOP 7.2 — Personnel Security outlines the process for vetting and safeguarding SHOC personnel, both internally and in coordination with outsourced security providers, ensuring that all staff, visitors, and contractors are appropriately vetted and trained.

SOP 7.3 — Facility and Equipment Security addresses the safeguarding of SHOC's physical assets, ensuring the security and functionality of critical assets during all stages of the mission cycle.

Mandate Reference

(a) SADC DRMSS 2025–2030; (b) SHOC Security Policy and Access Protocols; (c) Comprehensive Physical Security Assessment — SADC/3/5/2/139 (2022); (d) ISO 22301:2019 and ISO 45001:2018; (e) SHOC MOA; (f) UNDAC Handbook, 8th Edition (2024), Chapter C: UNDAC Mission Cycle.

2. Scope and Applicability

This SOP applies to: (a) all SHOC premises — headquarters, regional satellite offices, temporary coordination hubs, warehouses and field EOCs; (b) all SHOC staff listed in the SHOC organogram (Posts 1–23); (c) outsourced security and facilities management provider(s) contracted under MOUs and SLAs; (d) visitors and contractors, including NDMA delegations, international partners, vendors, technicians and media; and (e) all phases of the ERT Mission Cycle: Pre-Mission (routine operations and preparedness), On-Mission (heightened security posture, restricted access), and Mission-End (recovery, audits, and system strengthening).

The SOP covers facility and personnel access, physical security infrastructure activation, access log and CCTV data management, and incident reporting. It links directly to SOP 7.2 (Personnel Security), SOP 7.3 (Facility and Equipment Security), and SOP 5.1 (HR Recruitment and Mobilisation).

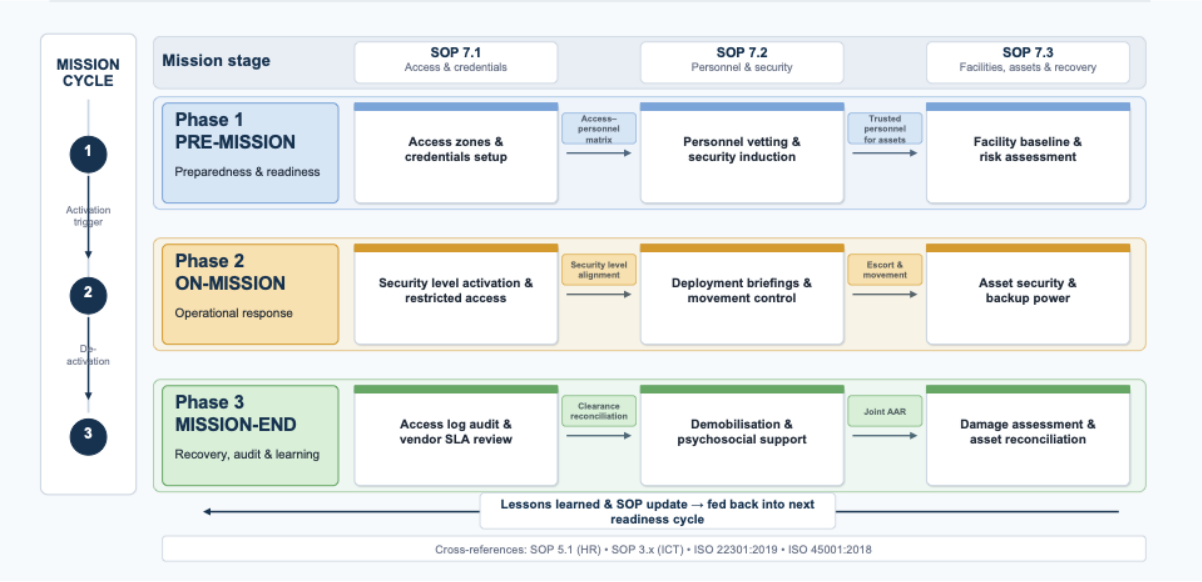
3. Guiding Principles

Principle	Description
Subsidiarity and Alignment	Member States maintain operational sovereignty; SHOC coordinates regional facility access standards.
Safety First	Protection of life and health overrides convenience or speed of access (ISO 45001 duty of care).
Accountability and Transparency	All access decisions and incidents must be logged, traceable and auditable.
Defence in Depth	Multiple, layered controls from perimeter to core assets (gates, guards, CCTV, credentials), informed by Physical Security Assessment.

Principle	Description
Interoperability	Physical access systems integrated with ICT, HR and risk registers, enabling analytics and early warning.
Do No Harm	Security measures must respect human rights, VPSHR, and avoid discrimination or unnecessary intrusion.
Continuous Improvement	Lessons from incidents, drills and audits are systematically captured and used to refine procedures.

SOP 7.1 — Access Control and Security Reporting

SOP 7.1 follows a three-phase, time-bound workflow aligned with the UNDAC ERT Mission Cycle:



Phase 1: Pre-Mission — Preparedness and Readiness

During normal operations, SHOC establishes and maintains the baseline access control environment: defining zones and clearance levels, configuring access technology (RFID, biometrics), onboarding outsourced security staff, and testing systems. This phase ensures that, when an emergency arises, the system can shift quickly into a heightened posture without confusion or manual workarounds.

Table 7.1.1: Pre-Mission Access Preparation

Step	Sub-Step / How To	Desired Output	Time Frame
1 — Map Facilities and Zones	1.1 Obtain latest floor plans and site layout. 1.2 Classify zones (Public, Controlled, Restricted, Critical) based on risk assessment and asset location.	Approved Access Zoning Map aligned to risk profile and asset locations.	Within 30 days of SOP entry into force; review annually.
2 — Define Access Levels and Credentials	2.1 Define clearance levels (Level 1–4). 2.2 Link levels to staff roles and outsourced security roles. 2.3 Configure badge/biometric profiles in Access Management System (AMS).	Role-based Access Control Matrix and configured AMS profiles.	Within 15 days after Step 1; update when organogram changes.
3 — Onboard Security Vendor	3.1 Finalise MOUs and SLAs specifying guard numbers, competencies, vetting,	Signed MOUs/SLAs with	Within 30 days of contract

Step	Sub-Step / How To	Desired Output	Time Frame
	shifts, and reporting lines. 3.2 Conduct joint induction for vendor supervisors and SHOC focal points.	KPIs and escalation thresholds (see Annex 7.C).	signature or renewal.
4 — Establish Visitor and Contractor Procedures	4.1 Approve visitor categories and authorisation rules. 4.2 Implement standard Visitor & Contractor Register (Annex 7.A). 4.3 Train reception and guards on procedures and VPSHR.	Standardised visitor workflow and documented logs; VPSHR-compliant searches.	Within 15 days of vendor onboarding; refresh training annually.
5 — Test Systems and Drills	5.1 Conduct functional tests of AMS, CCTV, alarms, barriers and backup power. 5.2 Run at least one lockdown and evacuation drill per year (see Annex 7.J). 5.3 Capture findings in Security Risk Register (Annex 7.D).	Tested, functioning systems with documented corrective actions.	Bi-annually, or after major upgrade.

Phase 2: On-Mission — Operational Response

When SHOC activates in response to a disaster, access control shifts from routine to heightened security posture. This includes tightening entry conditions, restricting certain zones, managing surge of visitors and partners, and ensuring that the EOC and critical assets are protected while still enabling rapid humanitarian coordination. Integration with the Incident Management System (IMS) and the Early Warning team is essential.

Table 7.1.2: On-Mission Access Operations

Step	Sub-Step / How To	Desired Output	Time Frame
1 — Activate Security Incident Level	1.1 Head of Operations, in consultation with ED and Early Warning Officer, declares Security Level (Green/Yellow/Orange/Red). 1.2 Notify security vendor and all staff via SMS/email and IM Portal.	Documented Security Level Declaration recorded in IMS and Security Log.	Within 1 hour of SHOC activation decision.
2 — Implement Restricted Access Plan	2.1 Lock non-essential entrances; channel all entry via main gate/reception. 2.2 Enforce “Need to Go / Need to Know” access rules for Restricted and Critical zones.	Access restricted to authorised personnel; clear perimeter and internal controls.	Within 2 hours of Level change.
3 — Surge Visitor and Partner Management	3.1 Require pre-registration for delegations where possible. 3.2 Verify ID and issue temporary badges with time-bound access. 3.3 Log all visitors/contractors in Visitor Register (Annex 7.A) and AMS.	Accurate, real-time list of all non-staff on premises.	Continuous; each visitor processed within 5–10 minutes.
4 — Real-Time Monitoring and Reporting	4.1 Control Room Operator monitors CCTV, access logs and alarms. 4.2 Use dashboards to track occupancy of EOC, operations rooms and critical areas. 4.3 Log anomalies and near-misses in Security Incident Form (Annex 7.B).	Real-time Access Situation Picture and incident log for decision-makers.	Continuous during activation; anomalies recorded within 15 minutes.
5 — Incident Escalation	5.1 For any suspected breach, vendor supervisor informs SHOC Security Focal Point immediately. 5.2 Head of Operations decides on local containment or facility lockdown. 5.3 Serious incidents (Orange/Red)	Timely containment of security events and documented escalation trail.	Initial notification within 10 minutes; full report within 2 hours.

Step	Sub-Step / How To	Desired Output	Time Frame
	escalated to ED and documented for possible law-enforcement referral.		

Phase 3: Mission-End — Recovery, Audit and Learning

After the acute phase, SHOC must reconcile access logs, identify weaknesses, and update systems and contracts. This phase ensures that lessons from each activation cycle are captured, mitigating future risks and strengthening business continuity and occupational safety.

Table 7.1.3: Mission-End Access Audit and Recovery

Step	Sub-Step / How To	Desired Output	Time Frame
1 — Access Log and CCTV Reconciliation	1.1 Export AMS access logs and Visitor Registers for activation period. 1.2 Sample-check against CCTV footage at peak times and known incidents. 1.3 Flag discrepancies (unlogged visitors, invalid badges).	Consolidated Access Audit Report with discrepancy list.	Within 10 working days of de-activation.
2 — Facilities and Asset Security Review	2.1 Inspect perimeter, doors, locks, barriers and control room equipment for damage or tampering. 2.2 Verify that high-value assets remained secure (link to SOP 7.3).	Facilities and Asset Security Status Report and maintenance requests.	Within 15 working days.
3 — Vendor Performance and SLA Review	3.1 Assess security company performance using SLA Compliance Checklist (Annex 7.C). 3.2 Document breaches, strengths and areas for improvement. 3.3 Provide written feedback and agree on corrective action plan.	Signed SLA Performance Review and improvement plan.	Within 20 working days.
4 — Lessons Learned and SOP Update	4.1 Conduct After-Action Review (AAR) with Operations, Early Warning, ICT, HR and security vendor. 4.2 Update Security Risk Register (Annex 7.D) and SHOC Risk Register. 4.3 Propose revisions to SOPs 7.1, 7.2 and 7.3 as needed.	Updated risk entries, agreed lessons and SOP amendment proposals.	Within 30 working days.

Risk Analysis

SOP 7.1 adopts the BGYOR (Blue–Green–Yellow–Orange–Red) risk rating system, with Risk Score = Likelihood × Impact. Inherent Risk is rated before mitigation; Residual Risk is rated after controls are implemented.

Table 7.1.4: BGYOR Colour Index

Colour	Rating	Value	Description
□ Blue	Very Low	1	Negligible impact; strong controls; rare occurrence.
□ Green	Low	2	Manageable via routine security and facilities controls.
□ Yellow	Medium	3	Requires active monitoring and periodic review.
□ Orange	High	4	Significant operational or safety impact if untreated.

Colour	Rating	Value	Description
□ Red	Critical	5	Could halt SHOC operations or cause serious harm.

Table 7.1.5: Access Control Risk Register (Extract)

#	Risk Description	Phase	Inherent	Key Controls	Residual
1	Unauthorised entry to Restricted or Critical zones.	All	20 □	Zoned access, AMS, guard supervision, CCTV, visitor escort, audits.	6 □
2	Failure of access control systems during operations.	On-Mission	15 □	UPS and generator, manual fallback, paper registers, sealed custody keys.	6 □
3	Vendor non-compliance with SLA.	All	16 □	MOU/SLA with KPIs, induction, VPSHR training, SLA checklist (Annex 7.C).	6 □
4	Insider threat bypassing controls.	All	15 □	Dual custody for keys, AMS log reviews, CCTV analytics, whistle-blower channels.	6 □
5	Overcrowding at entry points during emergencies.	On-Mission	12 □	Security Level protocols, dedicated entry lanes, surge management.	6 □
6	Loss or disclosure of visitor/access logs.	Mission-End	9 □	Secure digital storage, access-controlled filing, retention policies.	4 □

Roles and Responsibilities

The following table reflects the current SHOC staff complement and key external actors. Time thresholds refer to maximum allowable response times once a trigger condition is met. Contact details are placeholders to be populated in the final SHOC directory.

Table 7.1.6: SOP 7.1 Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Key Responsibilities	Time Threshold
Executive Director (1)	Approves Security Levels Orange/Red; signs MOUs/SLAs; approves facility lockdown; final recipient of critical incident reports.	Approve Level change ≤ 1 hr; sign critical incident report ≤ 24 hrs.
Head of Operations (3)	Leads operationalisation of SOP 7.1; declares Level Green/Yellow; chairs AAR; supervises vendor performance.	Security Level decision ≤ 1 hr; incident acknowledgement ≤ 30 min.
Head of Programmes (2)	Ensures programme teams respect access zones; coordinates with partners and visiting delegations.	Confirm access requirements ≥ 24 hrs before planned visits.
EW Officer (5) + EW Assistants (13–16)	Shares risk intelligence triggering security posture changes; ensures early warning feeds into access decisions.	Provide risk update when new hazard alert is issued; respond ≤ 1 hr.
Programme Officer (4)	Confirms activation status and staffing profile; ensures response teams comply with access and reporting.	Confirm deployment lists ≤ 2 hrs of activation.

Role	Key Responsibilities	Time Threshold
IM & Reporting Officer (6)	Maintains Security Incident database; integrates access data into situation reports; ensures data protection.	Update incident log within 2 hrs; include summaries in daily SitRep.
SCM Officer (7)	Coordinates access for deliveries, warehouses and fleet; ensures drivers and logistics assistants follow rules.	Approve delivery windows ≥ 24 hrs in advance; urgent requests ≤ 2 hrs.
Finance & Admin (8) + Asst (19)	Processes vendor payments, insurance for access systems, and budget for upgrades.	Approve emergency payments ≤ 48 hrs; confirm SLA payment monthly.
ICT Officer (9) + Asst (20)	Manages AMS, CCTV, network connectivity and backups; ensures system resilience (ISO 22301/45001).	Resolve critical outage ≤ 2 hrs; routine issues within 24 hrs.
Comms & PR Officer (10)	Manages public information on facility access restrictions and visitor protocols.	Issue public notice within 3 hrs of Level Orange/Red.
HR & Admin Asst (18) + Secretary (21)	Maintains access lists, staff clearance levels and contact directories.	Update access list within 24 hrs of staff change.
Drivers (22–23) + Logistics Asst (17)	Comply with vehicle access controls; support movement control.	Report security anomaly at gates immediately.
Outsourced Security — Contract Manager	Ensures SLA compliance, staffing levels, training, equipment.	Acknowledge critical incident ≤ 15 min; submit report ≤ 2 hrs.
Outsourced Security — Site Supervisor / Control Room	Implements SOP 7.1 on the ground: gate control, searches, CCTV, alarms, visitor management.	Screen each visitor within 5–10 min; log incident within 15 min.

Coordination and Communication

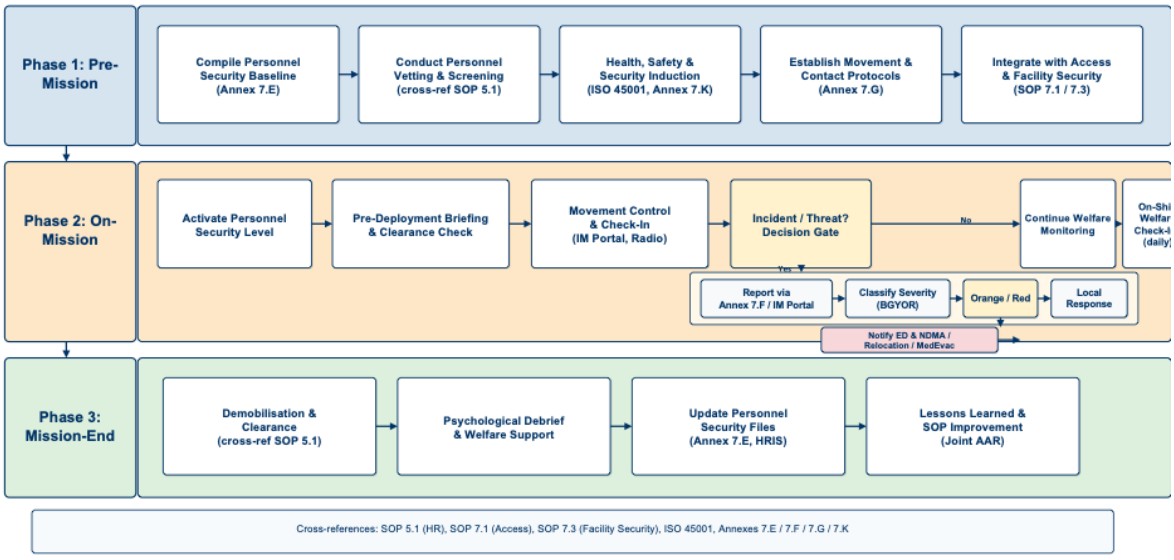
Primary coordination channel: Head of Operations ↔ Security Contract Manager ↔ ICT Officer. Operational platforms include the Incident Management Portal (IM Portal) with integrated access dashboards and the Security Risk Register (Annex 7.D) aligned with the SHOC Risk Register.

Escalation thresholds: Level Yellow: incident statistics or threat intelligence indicate elevated risk — Head Ops informed immediately. Level Orange: attempted or confirmed breach; ED and NDMA focal point informed ≤ 1 hour. Level Red: imminent threat to life or critical infrastructure — facility lockdown and law-enforcement notification.

Reporting cycle: Daily security updates during activation; monthly access incident summaries during routine operations; bi-annual consolidated security/access report linked to performance monitoring indicators.

SOP 7.2 — Personnel Security

This SOP applies to all SHOC staff in the current complement (Posts 1–23), any outsourced security and facilities personnel operating under MOUs and SLAs, and visitors, contractors and embedded partners whose deployment to SHOC premises or missions exposes them to security risks. It is interlinked with SOP 7.1 (access authorisation depends on personnel security status), SOP 7.3 (trusted personnel required for safe management of critical assets), and SOP 5.1 (HR policy alignment and surge staffing).



Phase 1: Pre-Mission — Preparedness and Readiness

SHOC must ensure that all staff and contracted personnel are appropriately vetted, inducted and prepared to operate in potentially high-risk environments. This phase focuses on background checks, clearance, health and safety readiness, and baseline welfare measures, establishing linkages to access control (SOP 7.1) and HR recruitment (SOP 5.1).

Table 7.2.1: Pre-Mission Personnel Security Preparedness

Step	Sub-Step / How To	Expected Output	Time Frame
1 — Compile Personnel Security Baseline	1.1 Extract current staff list from HR/organogram. 1.2 Classify roles by exposure (field, HQ, ICT, logistics, executive). 1.3 Identify posts requiring enhanced vetting.	Personnel Security Register (Annex 7.E) linked to HRIS.	Within 30 days; update quarterly. Cross-ref SOP 5.1.
2 — Conduct Personnel Vetting and Screening	2.1 Obtain and verify national ID, references, and employment history. 2.2 Request police clearance for high-risk positions. 2.3 Conduct conflict-of-interest and integrity checks per SADC HR policies.	Updated Vetting and Screening Dossier for each staff member.	Within 60 days for existing staff; within recruitment process for new staff (per SOP 5.1).
3 — Health, Safety and Security Induction	3.1 Enrol all staff in SHOC Security, OHS and Duty-of-Care induction (ISO 45001). 3.2 Cover modules: personal safety, facility security, information protection, incident reporting, VPSHR. 3.3 Record completion in HRIS and Training Log (Annex 7.K).	At least 90% of staff certified as “inducted” annually.	Within 90 days; annually thereafter.

Step	Sub-Step / How To	Expected Output	Time Frame
4 — Establish Personnel Movement and Contact Protocols	4.1 Maintain up-to-date contact details and next-of-kin information. 4.2 Define check-in/checkout rules for field movements (Annex 7.G). 4.3 Agree on escalation triggers for failure to check in.	Documented Movement and Contact Protocol (Annex 7.G) for all field-exposed roles.	Within 45 days; review annually or after critical incident.
5 — Integrate Personnel Security with Access and Facility Security	5.1 Share Personnel Security Register with Access Control focal point (SOP 7.1). 5.2 Identify staff authorised for high-risk zones and critical systems. 5.3 Coordinate with outsourced security vendor on escort rules and badge coding.	Fully integrated Access–Personnel Security Matrix (7.1 ↔ 7.2 ↔ 7.3).	Within 60 days; update whenever staffing changes.

Phase 2: On-Mission — Operational Response

When SHOC is activated, personnel security shifts to real-time protection and monitoring, including deployment briefings, adherence to movement protocols, coordination with outsourced security/facilities, and rapid reporting of threats, near-misses or incidents affecting staff.

Table 7.2.2: On-Mission Personnel Security Operations

Step	Sub-Step / How To	Expected Output	Time Frame
1 — Activate Personnel Security Level	1.1 Head of Operations sets Personnel Security Level (mirrored to SOP 7.1 facility Security Level). 1.2 Communicate level and key precautions to all staff via IM Portal, SMS and email.	Documented Personnel Security Level Notice.	Within 1 hour of SHOC activation or major threat change.
2 — Pre-Deployment Briefing and Clearance Check	2.1 Verify that all staff assigned to field duties have valid vetting records and induction. 2.2 Provide incident-specific security briefings. 2.3 Confirm emergency contacts and next-of-kin details.	Deployment Security Briefing Record per team.	Within 2 hours before departure / shift start.
3 — Movement Control and Check-In	3.1 Implement movement plan with scheduled check-ins (every 2–4 hours). 3.2 Use IM Portal, SMS or radio logs to record movements. 3.3 Outsourced provider to coordinate escorts where needed.	Real-time Movement Log for all deployed staff and drivers.	Continuous; missed check-in escalated within 30 minutes.
4 — Incident and Threat Reporting	4.1 Staff report threats, harassment, accidents using Personnel Security Incident Form (Annex 7.F) or IM Portal. 4.2 Head of Operations classifies severity (BGYOR) and initiates response. 4.3 Notify ED and NDMA if incident is Orange/Red.	Logged Personnel Security Incidents with documented mitigation.	Initial notification within 15 min for serious incidents; full report within 2 hrs.
5 — On-Shift Welfare Monitoring	5.1 Supervisors hold daily check-in sessions to monitor fatigue, stress and morale. 5.2 IM & Reporting Officer captures welfare concerns in daily SitRep. 5.3 Flag staff needing immediate support or rotation.	Embedded Welfare Notes in daily SitReps; early identification of at-risk staff.	Daily during activation; severe cases escalated immediately.

Phase 3: Mission-End — Recovery, Audit and Learning

SHOC must ensure safe demobilisation, address residual security or psychosocial impacts, and update the personnel security system based on lessons learned. This phase supports recovery, resilience and long-term continuity.

Table 7.2.3: Mission-End Personnel Security and Recovery

Step	Sub-Step / How To	Expected Output	Time Frame
1 — Demobilisation and Clearance	1.1 Confirm return of staff from field; reconcile movement logs. 1.2 De-activate temporary access rights and escort arrangements. 1.3 Capture end-of-mission security incidents not yet recorded.	Confirmed Demobilisation List and closed movement records.	Within 5 working days of de-activation. Cross-ref SOP 5.1.
2 — Psychological Debrief and Welfare Support	2.1 Organise group and/or individual psychological debriefs. 2.2 Provide referrals for ongoing psychosocial or medical support. 2.3 Document participation and follow-up decisions.	Debriefing and Support Log for all deployed staff.	Within 10–14 days of demobilisation.
3 — Personnel Security File Update	3.1 Update Personnel Security Register (Annex 7.E) with incidents, new training, or restrictions. 3.2 Incorporate lessons into individual security profiles.	Updated Personnel Security Files in HRIS.	Within 30 days.
4 — Lessons Learned and SOP Improvement	4.1 Participate in joint AAR with HR (SOP 5.1), Access Control (SOP 7.1) and Facility Security (SOP 7.3). 4.2 Revise risk register entries (Annex 7.D). 4.3 Propose updates to SOP 7.2 and annexes.	Personnel Security Lessons Learned Report and SOP revision proposals.	Within 30 days of AAR.

Risk Analysis

Table 7.2.4: Personnel Security Risk Register (Extract)

#	Risk Description	Phase	Inherent	Key Controls	Residual
1	Deployment of unvetted staff to high-risk environments.	Pre/On-Mission	20 □	Mandatory pre-deployment vetting; Personnel Security Register (Annex 7.E); integration with SOP 5.1 and 7.1.	6 □
2	Staff exposure to physical violence, harassment or abduction.	On-Mission	20 □	Security briefings; movement control; escorts; incident reporting; VPSHR alignment.	6 □
3	Insider threat (fraud, sabotage, data leakage).	All	15 □	Vetting; conflict-of-interest checks; access segregation; monitoring; link to SOP 7.3.	6 □
4	Burnout and psychosocial harm from prolonged operations.	On-Mission/End	16 □	OHS work/rest rules; daily welfare check-ins; debriefing and psychosocial support.	4 □
5	Unclear accountability between SHOC and outsourced provider.	All	12 □	MOUs/SLAs defining roles, incident reporting and escalation; RACI matrix.	4 □

#	Risk Description	Phase	Inherent	Key Controls	Residual
6	Loss or misuse of personnel security data.	All	9 □	Access-controlled HRIS; secure file storage; data protection policies.	4 □

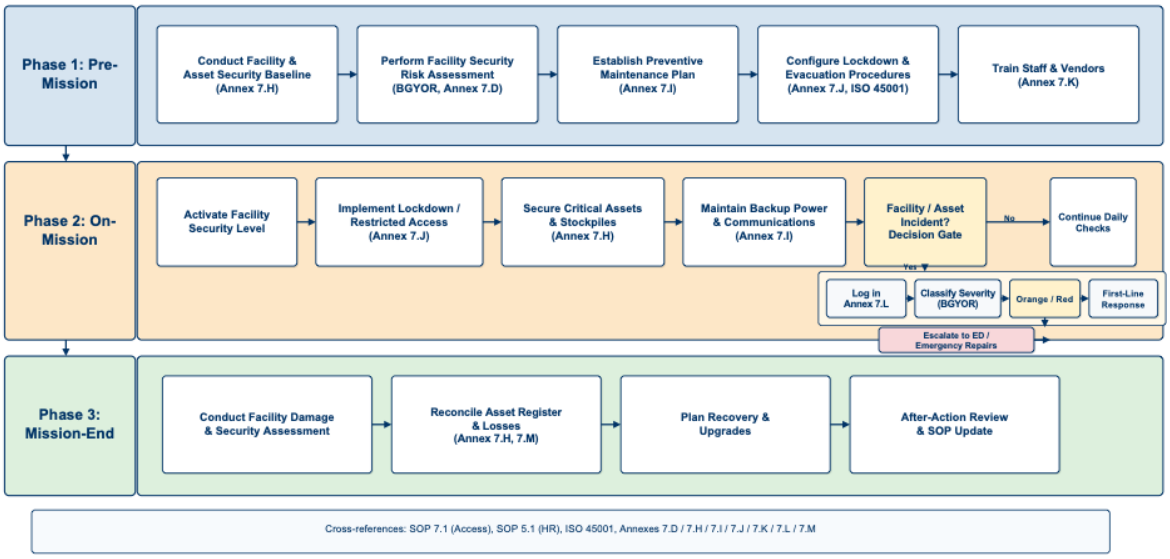
Roles and Responsibilities

Table 7.2.5: SOP 7.2 Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Key Responsibilities	Time Threshold
Executive Director (1)	Overall accountability for personnel security; approves Level Orange/Red; endorses Serious Incident Reports.	Approve Level ≤ 1 hr; sign serious incident report ≤ 24 hrs.
Head of Operations (3)	Operational lead; sets Personnel Security Level; approves deployments to high-risk areas; leads AAR.	Level change ≤ 1 hr; acknowledge critical incident ≤ 30 min.
Head of Programmes (2)	Ensures programme teams adhere to personnel security protocols and movement plans.	Staff deployment list ≥ 24 hrs before planned missions.
Programme Officer (4)	Coordinates deployment lists, shift patterns; confirms only cleared staff deployed.	Confirm team list and clearances ≤ 2 hrs after activation.
EW Officer (5) + Assistants (13–16)	Provide hazard and threat intelligence affecting staff safety.	Share new risk alert immediately; contribute to Level review within 1 hr.
IM & Reporting Officer (6)	Maintains Personnel Security Incident database and analytics.	Log incidents within 2 hrs; daily summaries during activation.
SCM Officer (7) + Logistics Asst (17)	Ensure safe logistics routes, vehicle allocation, and movement protocols.	Route plan ≥ 12 hrs before movement; update changes within 1 hr.
Finance & Admin (8) + Asst (19)	Manage insurance, compensation, medical coverage, duty-of-care budget.	Confirm cover within 48 hrs; process urgent claims within 5 days.
ICT Officer (9) + Asst (20)	Provide secure communication tools; maintain IM Portal and HRIS.	Resolve critical ICT issue ≤ 2 hrs.
Comms & PR Officer (10)	Coordinate external messaging on staff safety incidents.	Issue cleared statements within 3 hrs.
HR & Admin Asst (18) + Secretary (21)	Maintain Personnel Security Register, vetting files, training records.	Update register within 24 hrs of staff changes.
Translators (11–12)	Ensure security briefings understood by francophone and lusophone partners.	Translated briefings ≥ 24 hrs before multi-lingual missions.
Drivers (22–23)	Comply with movement plans; report route-related threats.	Report incidents immediately; confirm departure/arrival.
Outsourced Security Contract Manager	Ensures guards understand SHOC personnel security protocols.	Acknowledge critical incident ≤ 15 min; written report ≤ 2 hrs.

SOP 7.3 — Facility and Equipment Security

SOP 7.3 provides a standardised, auditable system for securing SHOC facilities, equipment and critical infrastructure during routine operations and emergency activation. It protects SHOC buildings, control rooms, data centres, EOCs, warehouses, vehicles and specialised equipment against theft, vandalism, sabotage, environmental hazards and disaster impacts. It is interlinked with SOP 7.1 (access control), SOP 7.2 (personnel security), and relevant ICT continuity SOPs.



Phase 1: Pre-Mission — Preparedness and Readiness

SHOC ensures that all facilities and critical assets are known, documented, secure and maintained. This includes facility risk assessments, asset registration, preventive maintenance, testing of CCTV and alarms, and verification of insurance coverage. Day-to-day work is carried out by outsourced providers, but SHOC retains responsibility for risk oversight and compliance with ISO 22301 and 45001.

Table 7.3.1: Pre-Mission Facility and Equipment Security Preparedness

Step	Sub-Step / How To	Expected Output	Time Frame
1 — Conduct Facility and Asset Security Baseline	1.1 Compile facility list. 1.2 Map critical zones (perimeter, server rooms, safe rooms, vaults, stockpile areas). 1.3 Cross-check with Asset Register (Annex 7.H).	Approved Facility and Asset Security Baseline.	Within 60 days; review annually.
2 — Perform Facility Security Risk Assessment	2.1 Use Physical Security Assessment methodology to identify threats, vulnerabilities and controls. 2.2 Rate risks using BGYOR matrix. 2.3 Populate Security Risk Register (Annex 7.D).	Facility Security Risk Assessment Report per site.	Within 90 days; then bi-annually.
3 — Establish Preventive Maintenance Plan	3.1 Define maintenance schedule for alarms, CCTV, UPS, generators, fire systems (Annex 7.I). 3.2 Record tasks with responsibilities and timelines. 3.3 Include periodic insurance and asset valuation checks.	Approved Preventive Maintenance Plan (Annex 7.I).	Plan finalised within 60 days; quarterly checks.

Step	Sub-Step / How To	Expected Output	Time Frame
4 — Configure Lockdown and Evacuation Procedures	4.1 Identify lockdown levels and triggers (linked to SOP 7.1 and 7.2). 4.2 Map evacuation routes, assembly points and safe rooms. 4.3 Integrate with OHS and fire safety plans (ISO 45001). See Annex 7.J.	Written Lockdown and Evacuation Procedures (Annex 7.J).	Within 90 days; tested annually through drills.
5 — Train Staff and Vendors	5.1 Include facility/equipment security in annual security induction. 5.2 Provide role-specific training to drivers, ICT staff, warehouse staff, and security guards. 5.3 Record attendance in Training Log (Annex 7.K).	At least 90% of relevant staff and vendor personnel trained.	Induction within 90 days; refreshers annually.

Phase 2: On-Mission — Operational Response

During disaster activation, SHOC facilities may operate at elevated occupancy and intensity, and may be exposed to external threats or hazard impacts. SOP 7.3 ensures that critical assets remain available and secure, facility structures are protected, and any damage or outage is rapidly mitigated through backup systems and vendor support.

Table 7.3.2: On-Mission Facility and Equipment Security Operations

Step	Sub-Step / How To	Expected Output	Time Frame
1 — Activate Facility Security Level	1.1 Head of Operations sets Facility Security Level (aligned with Personnel and Access Levels). 1.2 Notify security/FM vendors and all staff of level, restrictions and backup arrangements.	Documented Facility Security Level Notice.	Within 1 hour of SHOC activation.
2 — Implement Lockdown / Restricted Access	2.1 Initiate partial or full lockdown per facility plan (Annex 7.J). 2.2 Secure secondary entrances, roof access, plant rooms and loading bays. 2.3 Ensure guards manage entry/exit in line with SOP 7.1.	Facility entry/exit clearly controlled; non-essential access suspended.	Within 2 hours of level change.
3 — Secure Critical Assets and Stockpiles	3.1 Confirm ICT rooms, safe rooms, vaults and sensitive storage are locked and monitored. 3.2 Ensure physical security for warehouses and stockpiles (Annex 7.H). 3.3 Coordinate with SCM Officer on securing relief items and vehicles.	Verified Critical Asset Security Checklist.	Initial verification within 4 hours; re-checked daily.
4 — Maintain Backup Power and Communications	4.1 Activate backup systems (UPS, generators) when power instability detected. 4.2 Maintain adequate fuel and spares; record run hours (Annex 7.I). 4.3 Coordinate with ICT to prioritise power to control room, server room, EOC.	Stable power and communications continuity for critical operations.	Backup activated within minutes of failure; fuel checked daily.
5 — Monitor and Respond to Facility/Asset Incidents	5.1 Log all facility/asset incidents in Facility Incident Form (Annex 7.L). 5.2 Classify severity using BGYOR and decide containment measures. 5.3 Escalate Orange/Red incidents to Head of Operations, ED.	Logged Facility and Equipment Incident Register.	Initial log within 15 min; full report within 2 hrs.

Phase 3: Mission-End — Recovery, Audit and Learning

After the crisis phase, SHOC must assess damage, recover and replace assets, close security gaps and integrate lessons learned into future planning and design. This phase completes the cycle linking facility security with business continuity, insurance, budgeting and asset management.

Table 7.3.3: Mission-End Facility and Equipment Security and Recovery

Step	Sub-Step / How To	Expected Output	Time Frame
1 — Conduct Facility Damage Assessment	1.1 Deploy multidisciplinary team to inspect each affected facility. 1.2 Document structural damage, breached barriers, damaged systems, asset losses. 1.3 Update Risk Register (Annex 7.D).	Post-Disaster Facility Damage & Security Assessment Report.	Within 10 working days.
2 — Reconcile Asset Register and Losses	2.1 Compare pre-disaster Asset Register (Annex 7.H) with current inventory. 2.2 Record losses, damage and repairs; classify as insured/uninsured. 2.3 Provide data to Finance & Admin for claims and budgeting (Annex 7.M).	Reconciled Asset Loss and Recovery Statement (Annex 7.M).	Within 20 working days.
3 — Plan and Implement Recovery and Upgrades	3.1 Prioritise repairs focusing on high-risk vulnerabilities. 3.2 Coordinate procurement with SCM and Finance & Admin. 3.3 Update MOUs/SLAs with vendors where standards change.	Approved Facility and Equipment Recovery Plan.	Plan within 30 days; implementation per funding cycles.
4 — After-Action Review and SOP Update	4.1 Conduct AAR focusing on facility and equipment security performance. 4.2 Identify lessons learned, good practice and gaps. 4.3 Propose specific improvements and revisions to SOP 7.3.	Facility & Equipment Security Lessons Learned Report; SOP update proposal.	Within 45 days of de-activation.

Risk Analysis

Table 7.3.4: Facility and Equipment Security Risk Register (Extract)

#	Risk Description	Phase	Inherent	Key Controls	Residual
1	Perimeter breach and unauthorised entry without detection.	All	20 □	Perimeter lighting, fences, barriers; CCTV; guard patrols; integration with SOP 7.1.	6 □
2	Failure of CCTV or alarm systems during operations.	On-Mission	16 □	Preventive maintenance (Annex 7.I); redundant coverage; manual patrols; UPS/generator.	6 □
3	Loss or theft of high-value ICT equipment or stockpiles.	All	20 □	Secure storage; restricted access; inventory controls (Annex 7.H); vendor escorts.	6 □
4	Extended power outage affecting control rooms and data centres.	On-Mission	15 □	UPS and generator capacity (Annex 7.I); fuel management; IT continuity (ISO 22301/27001).	6 □

#	Risk Description	Phase	Inherent	Key Controls	Residual
5	Structural damage from hazard events.	On-Mission/End	15 □	Site selection standards; safe rooms; equipment anchoring; insurance; contingency plans.	6 □
6	Poor coordination with outsourced vendors.	All	12 □	MOUs/SLAs; coordination meetings; SLA reviews (Annex 7.C); joint training.	4 □
7	Loss or manipulation of asset registry data.	All	9 □	Digitised and backed-up Asset Register (Annex 7.H); restricted access; regular reconciliation.	4 □

Roles and Responsibilities

Table 7.3.5: SOP 7.3 Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Key Responsibilities	Time Threshold
Executive Director (1)	Overall accountability for facility and equipment security; approves high-cost upgrades; endorses Level Orange/Red.	Approve Level ≤ 1 hr; endorse major incident report ≤ 5 days.
Head of Operations (3)	Operational lead; sets Facility Security Level; chairs AARs; supervises security/FM vendors.	Level change ≤ 1 hr; acknowledge critical incident ≤ 30 min.
Head of Programmes (2)	Coordinate programmatic use of facilities and warehouses; ensure programmes respect security measures.	Confirm facility requirements ≥ 48 hrs before major activations.
SCM Officer (7) + Logistics Asst (17)	Maintain Asset Register (Annex 7.H) and warehouse security; lead asset reconciliation post-mission.	Update Asset Register monthly; submit loss statement within 20 days.
ICT Officer (9) + Asst (20)	Secure ICT infrastructure; manage backup power for ICT; implement ISO 22301/27001 controls.	Resolve critical outage ≤ 2 hrs; confirm daily system status during activation.
Finance & Admin (8) + Asst (19)	Manage facility insurance, budgeting and procurement of upgrades; process claims and vendor payments.	Verify insurance annually; initiate claims within 10 days.
EW Officer (5) + Assistants (13–16)	Provide hazard intel relevant to facilities (flood risk, severe weather, unrest).	Issue hazard alerts per EW protocols; brief Head Ops within 2 hrs.
IM & Reporting Officer (6)	Maintain Facility Incident Register and risk analytics.	Log incidents within 2 hrs; provide monthly facility security summary.
Comms & PR Officer (10)	Coordinate public messaging on facility impacts, closures or relocations.	Issue notice within 3 hrs of major facility impact.
HR & Admin Asst (18) + Secretary (21)	Maintain contact lists and duty rosters; coordinate facility-related meetings.	Update lists within 24 hrs; circulate minutes within 3 days.
Drivers (22–23)	Secure vehicles and parking areas; report suspicious activity or damage.	Report immediately; confirm vehicle status at shift start/end.

Role	Key Responsibilities	Time Threshold
Outsourced Security/FM Contract Manager	Ensures guards and technicians adhere to SOP 7.3; maintains patrols, CCTV and alarm monitoring.	Acknowledge critical incident ≤ 15 min; submit report ≤ 2 hrs.

- END OF SOPs -

Combined RACI Matrix

The RACI matrix clarifies roles for key activities across SOPs 7.1, 7.2, and 7.3, identifying who is Responsible (R), Accountable (A), Consulted (C), and Informed (I).

Activity	ED	H.Ops	H.Prog	EW	Prog	IM	SCM	ICT	Fin	HR	Sec.CM	Guards
Define access zones and levels	A	R	C	C	C	C	C	C	C	C	I	I
Approve/manage security vendor MOUs/SLAs	A	R	I	I	I	C	C	C	I	R	I	I
Pre-Mission access control	I	A	I	I	I	C	C	I	C	R	R	I
Declare/adjust Security Levels	A	R	C	C	C	I	I	C	I	I	I	C
Visitor and contractor management	I	A	C	I	C	I	C	I	R	R	R	C
Real-time monitoring and incident logging	I	A	I	I	C	I	C	I	I	C	R	I
Incident escalation and facility lockdown	A	R	I	C	C	C	C	I	I	C	R	C
Post-incident audit and lessons learned	A	R	C	C	C	R	C	C	C	C	C	C
SLA performance review	A	R	I	I	C	C	C	C	I	R	I	I

Monitoring and Evaluation

Table 5.1: Performance Monitoring Indicators

KPI	Indicator	Frequency	Responsible
Access Incident Rate	Number of access breaches or near-misses per month, categorised by severity.	Monthly	Head Ops; IM; Security Contract Manager.
Facility Security Readiness	Percentage of SHOC facilities compliant with SOP 7.1 checks (Annex 7.N).	Bi-annual	Head Ops; SCM Officer; ICT Officer.
SLA Compliance	Percentage of SLA KPIs met by security vendors.	Quarterly	Head Ops; Finance; Security Contract Manager.
Training Completion	Percentage of staff and vendor guards completing annual security induction.	Annual	HR & Admin Asst; Site Supervisor.
Risk Register Currency	Number of months since last update to security/access risks in the Risk Register (Annex 7.D).	Bi-annual	Head Ops; IM & Reporting.

Abbreviations

Abbreviation	Meaning
AMS	Access Management System
AAR	After-Action Review
BGYOR	Blue, Green, Yellow, Orange, Red (risk colour coding)
CCTV	Closed-Circuit Television
EOC	Emergency Operations Centre
ERT	Emergency Response Team
HRIS	Human Resources Information System
IMS / IM Portal	Incident Management System / Portal
ISO	International Organization for Standardization
MOUs	Memoranda of Understanding
NDMA	National Disaster Management Authority
RACI	Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, Informed
SADC	Southern African Development Community
SHOC	SADC Humanitarian and Emergency Operations Centre
SLA	Service Level Agreement
UNDAC	United Nations Disaster Assessment and Coordination
UPS	Uninterruptible Power Supply
VPSHR	Voluntary Principles on Security and Human Rights

Glossary of Key Terms

Access Control: The combination of policies, technologies, procedures, and human actions that regulate who may enter a facility or zone, when, and under what conditions.

Critical Zone: Areas where disruption or compromise could significantly affect SHOC's ability to operate (e.g., control room, servers, main EOC, high-sensitivity storage).

Defence in Depth: A layered security approach where multiple independent controls protect the same assets, reducing the chance that a single failure causes a breach.

Inherent Risk: The level of risk that exists in the absence of any controls or mitigation measures.

Mission Cycle: The UNDAC ERT operational framework comprising Pre-Mission, On-Mission, and Mission-End phases, adapted in this volume to SHOC's security and access context.

Residual Risk: The remaining level of risk after SOPs, technologies, and other controls have been implemented.

Security Level (Green/Yellow/Orange/Red): Pre-defined access and security posture states driving specific procedures in this SOP.

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Annex Register

The following annexes support SOPs 7.1, 7.2 and 7.3 and are maintained as separate controlled documents within the SHOC document management system.

Annex ID	Title	Linked SOP(s)
7.A	Visitor and Contractor Register	7.1
7.B	Security Incident / Breach Report Form	7.1 / 7.2
7.C	SLA Compliance Checklist	7.1 / 7.3
7.D	Security Risk Register Template	7.1 / 7.2 / 7.3
7.E	Personnel Security Register Template	7.2
7.F	Personnel Security Incident Form	7.2
7.G	Movement and Contact Protocol Template	7.2
7.H	Facility and Asset Security Baseline Template	7.3
7.I	Preventive Maintenance Plan Template	7.3
7.J	Lockdown and Evacuation Procedures Template	7.1 / 7.3
7.K	Training Log	7.2 / 7.3
7.L	Facility Incident Form	7.3
7.M	Asset Loss and Recovery Statement Template	7.3
7.N	Facility Compliance Checklist (M&E)	7.1 / 7.3

Document Version Control

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1.0	Dingaan Mahlangu	SOP Author	30 November 2025	First Draft
2.0	SHOC / Dr Cliff	SOP Revision (UNDAC Lifecycle Alignment)	2026	Revised Draft

Approval

Title	Name and Surname	Designation	Date	Signature